

## What is Software?

### Learning Objectives

- Define software and distinguish it from hardware
- Identify different types of software
- Explain how software makes computers useful

### Engage (5-7 minutes)

Think of a tractor—it is just metal and parts without a driver and instructions. Hardware is the machine, but software is the instructions that make it work. A computer without software is like a bullock cart without a yoke. Today we learn what software is and why it matters.

### Explore (10-12 minutes)

Look at the computer screen. The icons you see, the windows that open, the programs you use—all are software. List every program you can find on the computer. Compare hardware (what you can touch) with software (what you cannot touch but runs on the hardware).

### Explain (10-12 minutes)

Software is a set of instructions that tells hardware what to do. Hardware is the physical parts you can touch—keyboard, screen, mouse. Without software, hardware cannot perform any task. Software comes in many forms: operating systems, applications, and utility programs.

### Elaborate (8-10 minutes)

Think of your school. The building is hardware, but the teachers and their lessons are the software that makes learning happen. Write five examples of software you use daily and explain what each one does. Discuss with a partner why a computer cannot work without software.

### Evaluate (5-8 minutes)

Exit ticket: Define software in your own words. Give two examples of hardware and two of software. If hardware is the body, what is software? Explain with a rural Karnataka analogy.